NEW CEO BRIEFING

Christian Westerlind Wigstrom

Who Redbelly Network's incoming Chief Executive is, what Redbelly said when it appointed him, and what his track record could mean for Tokeniser.

ANNOUNCED	START DATE	PREVIOUSLY	SOURCES CHECKED
16 September 2026[1]	2 November 2026[2]	Co-founder & CEO, Monoova	30 October 2026

9.5 years
leading payments company Monoova, which he co-founded[3]

~$200bn
in payments processed by Monoova since he joined, per the company[3]

2022
Monoova named FinTech Organisation of the Year at the Finnies[4]

2 boards
FinTech Australia director; alternate director at AusPayNet[5,6]

IN BRIEF

- **The news.** On 16 September 2026, Redbelly Network named Christian Westerlind Wigstrom as Chief Executive Officer, to lead "the company's push into regulated tokenisation".[1,7] Banking Day reported his start date as 2 November 2026.[2]
- **Who he is.** A payments entrepreneur: co-founder of Australian payments company Monoova, which he led for about 9.5 years until 1 July 2026.[3,8] SMBtech said his background sits "firmly within traditional regulated finance rather than the crypto sector".[9]
- **Redbelly's reasoning.** It wants to apply his payments thinking (infrastructure good enough to "disappear into the background") to tokenised capital markets, as Australia's new digital assets law takes effect in April 2027.[1,10]
- **What it could mean (our analysis).** His record suggests Tokeniser will be run like payments infrastructure: sold through partners, compliance built in, a gradual path off older systems (section 03).

01 Professional background

FACT · SOURCED

Before Monoova

A published contributor profile states that, while completing a PhD at Oxford, he worked as an economic adviser and speech writer in the UK Parliament.[11] He then spent three years as Chief of Staff and Markets at a large agricultural start-up in Zimbabwe.[11]

Monoova, 2017 to 2026

Monoova is a Sydney-based payment service provider.[11,12] Its software lets other businesses receive, manage and send money through Australia's payment systems, from real-time bank payments to BPAY and direct debit.[12,13] The company says it has operated since 2017,[14] and credits him, as co-founder, with growing "what was initially Moneytech Payments" over 9.5 years.[3] Bianca Bates took over as CEO on 1 July 2026; he stayed on as an adviser to the Chair during the transition.[3,13]

EARLIER CAREER
UK Parliament economic adviser; agribusiness role in Zimbabwe[11]

2017
Monoova begins operating, with him as co-founder[14,3]

JUN 2022
Monoova wins FinTech Organisation of the Year[4]

DEC 2022
Elected to the FinTech Australia board[5]

2023–2024
FinTech Australia Treasurer (Nov 2023); re-elected 2024[15,16,17]

MAR 2025
Alternate Director, Australian Payments Network[6]

Monoova's record under his leadership · figures as published by Monoova or Redbelly; self-reported, not audited

AREA	WHAT THE SOURCES SAY
Scale	Close to $200bn in payments processed since he joined; transacts with more than 10% of all Australians.[3]
Clients	From fintechs such as Hnry to listed businesses such as Carsales.[3] Redbelly also names Wise.[1]
PayTo	Called itself "the largest facilitator of PayTo" in March 2024,[18] and says that by mid-2024 it handled "a comfortable majority of all PayTo activity".[14]
PayID	An early New Payments Platform participant and early mover on PayID.[18] Redbelly says Monoova issued "almost a quarter" of Australia's PayIDs;[1] Monoova's own April 2024 figure was 18%.[12]
Recognition	FinTech Organisation of the Year, 2022 Finnies.[4] He was a finalist for Outstanding Business Leader at the 2025 Sydney Business Awards.[14]
Industry roles	FinTech Australia director from December 2022; Treasurer from November 2023; re-elected 2024.[5,15,16,17] Alternate Director of AusPayNet, the payments industry's self-regulatory body, from March 2025, elected by non-bank payment providers.[6] Banking Day reported both roles as current in September 2026.[2]

PLAIN ENGLISH · KEY TERMS

New Payments Platform (NPP)
Australia's real-time payment system, used for PayID and PayTo payments.[12]

PayID
An easy-to-remember identifier, such as a mobile number or email address, linked to a bank account.[19]

PayTo
A customer approves an agreement in their online banking; the business can then take payments from their account.[20,12]

Payment service provider (PSP)
A company connecting businesses to payment systems, usually via software interfaces (APIs).[12]

Tokenisation
Recording ownership of a financial product as a digital token whose rules can be programmed.[21]

Wholesale CBDC (wCBDC)
A tokenised form of central bank money, tested in pilot form in Project Acacia.[22]

02 What Redbelly said

FACT · SOURCED

Redbelly announced the appointment on 16 September 2026. The text also went out as a press release on Medianet and was covered by SMBtech and Banking Day.[1,7,9,2]

- **Mandate.** He "joins to lead the company's push into regulated tokenisation".[1]
- **The idea he brings.** Redbelly says one idea was critical at Monoova: "payments infrastructure must be good enough to disappear into the background". He is now applying it to regulated capital-markets infrastructure.[1]
- **Why now.** Redbelly ties the hire to the Corporations Amendment (Digital Assets Framework) Act, which it says brings digital-asset and tokenised-custody platforms into the same licensing regime as brokers and fund managers.[1] The Act received Royal Assent on 8 April 2026 and commences in April 2027.[10]
- **The network's credentials.** Redbelly cites Project Acacia, a research program led by the Reserve Bank of Australia (RBA) and the Digital Finance Cooperative Research Centre that tested 20 tokenised-market use cases.[23] The RBA's final report confirms Redbelly Network ("a public-permissioned blockchain") was one of three platforms used in experiments with a pilot wholesale CBDC.[22] Redbelly calls itself "the only public Layer 1 carrying real central bank claims on public infrastructure".[1]
- **Positioning.** Redbelly describes itself as "the settlement layer for regulated markets", with its tokenisation strategy "delivered through Tokeniser".[1]

> "One of Redbelly's many strengths is its regulatory credibility. In payments, I learnt that success belonged to the company that saw compliance as a product edge rather than a tick box. The same thing applies to capital-markets infrastructure. As new regulation takes effect, this insight stops being philosophical and starts being existential.
>
> CHRISTIAN WESTERLIND WIGSTROM · REDBELLY ANNOUNCEMENT[1]

> "The next era of finance won't be won by the loudest chain. It'll be won by the chain that institutions can actually use.
>
> CHRISTIAN WESTERLIND WIGSTROM · REDBELLY ANNOUNCEMENT[1]

TOKENISER, IN BRIEF

- Tokeniser is “a Redbelly Network project”, born from research at the University of Sydney and CSIRO.[24] Banking Day reports it is anchored in patented research led by Redbelly's founder and CTO, Professor Vincent Gramoli.[2]
- It is software for fund administration and investor portals that runs on Redbelly Network.[21] Investor checks, such as identity, KYC, AML and wholesale-investor tests, are programmed into each asset.[21] Banking Day describes it as covering the “origination, administration and end-to-end lifecycle servicing” of tokenised assets such as equities, bonds and private credit.[2]
- Products issued through it operate under the issuer's existing licence.[21] It works with IQ-EQ for clients that need a globally licensed operator.[24] In Project Acacia, Tokeniser Pty Ltd collaborated on two pilots on Redbelly Network: a tokenised fund and a tokenised corporate bond.[22]

03 What his track record could mean for Tokeniser

ANALYSIS · NOT FACT

READ AS INTERPRETATION This section draws conclusions from the sourced facts above. It does not describe Redbelly's announced plans, and it is not a forecast or financial advice.

01 Infrastructure that works behind other brands

RECORD Redbelly says Monoova reached its scale by acting “behind the scenes” of other brands, with clients such as Carsales, Hnry and Wise.[1,3] He has said a great payment experience “should be remarkable only by virtue of how unremarkable it is”.[12]

COULD MEAN Tokeniser may grow mainly through partners (fund administrators, registries, trustees and platforms) that build it into their own services, rather than through direct marketing. Its IQ-EQ relationship is an early example of that channel.[24]

02 Compliance as part of the product

RECORD He says success in payments went to the company that saw compliance as “a product edge rather than a tick box”,[1] and he has held board roles at FinTech Australia and at AusPayNet, a self-regulatory body.[5,6]

COULD MEAN With the Digital Assets Framework starting in April 2027,[10] Tokeniser's built-in investor checks[21] are likely to become a headline selling point. Redbelly may also become more visible in industry and regulator forums, such as the post-Acacia work on a regulatory sandbox.[23]

03 A bridge from old systems to new ones

RECORD Monoova offered traditional payment methods next to real-time ones to “build a bridge to that future”. It brought clients onto PayTo “through education and implementation”.[12]

COULD MEAN Tokeniser already lets clients “run the new rails alongside existing administration”.[21] Expect more of this: step-by-step migration, client education and links to existing systems, rather than asking institutions to switch all at once.

04 Usage as the measure of progress

RECORD Monoova's track record is told in usage terms: payment volumes, share of PayTo activity, PayIDs issued.[3,18]

COULD MEAN Updates to the community may focus more on adoption (issuers onboarded, assets administered, transactions settled) than on technical milestones.

OPEN QUESTIONS · WHAT TO WATCH

- **Payments and capital markets are different.** Tokeniser is built for funds, corporate registries and asset administrators,[21] a different market from payments. The sources reviewed show no earlier executive role for him in capital markets or blockchain; Redbelly answers this by calling him “not a crypto tourist”.[1] How his experience carries over is yet to be shown.
- **No published plan yet.** The sources reviewed (to 30 October 2026) include no strategy, targets or timeline from the incoming CEO. His first statements after 2 November will be the best guide.
- **Self-reported numbers.** Monoova's figures come from the company itself and are not independently audited.
- **No market view.** This briefing makes no statement about the price or value of any token or asset.

04 Sources

ACCESSED 30 OCTOBER 2026

How this briefing was made. Every factual statement links to its source, numbered in order of first use. Each source was opened on 30 October 2026, and the passage that supports each statement is quoted in the companion source list. Facts and analysis sit in separate, labelled sections. Where sources differ, both are shown. Only public, professional information is included. The LinkedIn profile named in the brief requires a login and could not be checked, so no statement relies on it.

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Redbelly Network (official blog) · 16 September 2026
redbelly.network/blog/redbelly-new-CEO-is-a-payments-pioneer-betting-on-regulated-tokenisation

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www.bankingday.com/redbelly-announces-paytech-co-founder-christian-westerlind-wigstrom-as-ceo-to-push-into-tokenisation

3 **Monoova appoints Bianca Bates as CEO, as Christian Westerlind Wigstrom steps down**
Monoova (newsroom) · 18 May 2026
www.monoova.com/newsroom/monoova-appoints-bianca-bates-as-ceo

4 **FinTech Australia Announces 2022 Finnies Award Winners**
FinTech Australia · 24 June 2022
www.fintechaustralia.org.au/community-news/fintech-australia-announces-2022-finnies-award-winners

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Monoova (blog) · 1 December 2022
www.monoova.com/blog/fintech-australia-announces-new-board-appointment

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www.monoova.com/blog/who-are-monova-and-what-do-we-do-a-chat-with-christian-westerlind-wigstrom

13 **Monoova Appoints Payments Industry Executive Bianca Bates as CEO**
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16 **CEO of Monoova re-elected as Director at Fintech Australia**
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monoova.com/newsroom/christian-westerlind-wigstrom-re-elected-as-director-at-fintech-australia

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About this briefing. An independent community briefing prepared for the Redbelly DAO so members have an accurate, sourced reference before the new CEO starts. It is not an official statement of Redbelly Network Pty Ltd or Tokeniser Pty Ltd.

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